

MyDAW Operation Manual

From your first recording to editing, mixing and exporting

Version 1.6

MyDAW is Mac software (a DAW) for recording sound from a microphone or audio interface and for playing back, editing and mixing many tracks together.

This manual follows the order in which you actually work, so that even first-time DAW users will not get lost. Start by reading chapters 2 to 5 in order while you record your first song.

The screens can be shown in English or Japanese (chapter 15). This manual describes the English screens.

Contents

1. What you can do with MyDAW
2. Getting ready
3. The main window
4. Your first recording
5. Playback and basic controls
6. Editing clips
7. Punch-in recording and layered takes
8. Recording through effects (input monitoring)
9. Using the mixer
10. Effects (plug-ins) and FX channels
11. Tempo, click and ruler
12. Adjusting the view
13. Saving, opening and moving projects
14. Importing WAV files and exporting
15. Settings (audio and language)
16. Keyboard shortcuts
17. Troubleshooting
18. Glossary

1. What you can do with MyDAW

- **Record** in mono or stereo on as many tracks as you like, at 24-bit and 44.1, 48, 88.2 or 96 kHz.
- **Overdub**: record a new track while listening to tracks you have already recorded.
- **Punch in**: re-record just the part that went wrong. The joins are smoothed automatically.
- **Edit** recordings (clips): move, trim, split, duplicate, change volume, fade (with adjustable curves), normalize and reverse. Select several clips or a time range at once and cut, copy and paste. Everything can be undone.
- **Mix** with faders, pan, mute, solo and meters.
- **Use effects**: Audio Unit (AU) and VST3 plug-ins such as compressors, EQs, reverbs and amp simulators.
- **Export** the finished mix as one WAV file.

2. Getting ready

What you need

- A Mac with Apple Silicon (macOS 13 or later)
- A microphone or an audio interface (the Mac's built-in microphone also works)
- Headphones (if you use speakers while recording, the microphone picks them up)

Start MyDAW and choose a project

- 1 Double-click `MyDAW.app`.
- 2 On the start screen choose **New Project** or **Open Project** (to continue earlier work).
- 3 For **New Project**, choose (or create) a folder for the project. MyDAW creates a `.mydaw` file with the folder's name and a `Recordings` folder for your audio inside it.
- 4 For **Open Project**, choose the folder of an existing project.

First launch only When macOS asks whether “MyDAW” may access the microphone, choose **Allow**. Without it you cannot record.

Plug-in scan Right after launch, a log shows MyDAW looking for installed plug-ins. From the second launch on this takes almost no time.

One-time setup

Click the gear button  at the top to open **Settings** and select your equipment (details in chapter 15).

- 1 Choose your audio interface for **Input device** and **Output device**.
- 2 Set **Buffer size** to **256** to start with.
- 3 Click **Apply**. If you changed a device, choose **Save and Restart** when MyDAW asks to restart.

Screen language At first the screens follow the macOS language (Japanese or English). You can choose “English” or “日本語” under **Language** in Settings (chapter 15).

3. The main window

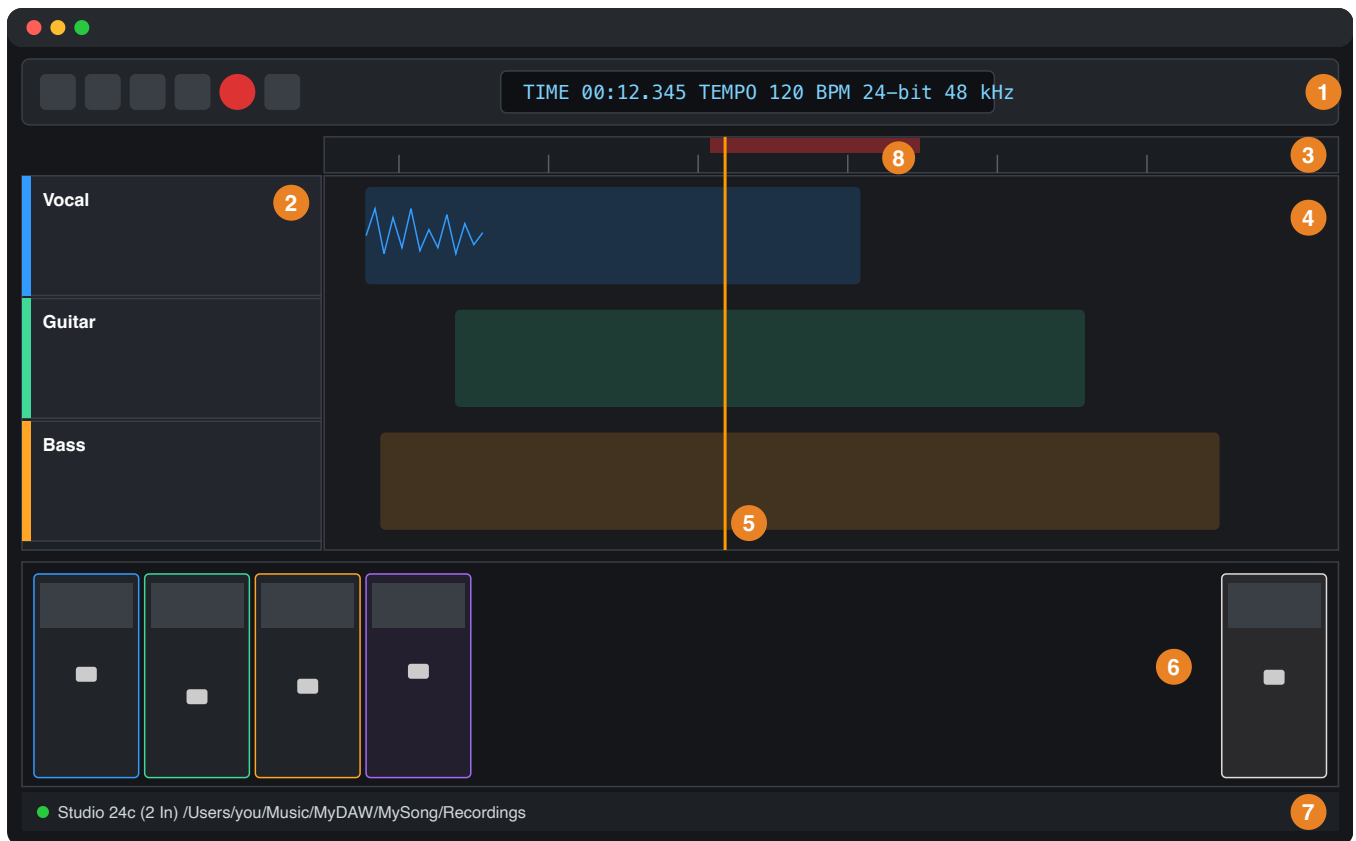


Figure 3-1 Layout of the main window

1	Transport bar: buttons for play, record, save and so on, plus time and tempo displays.
2	Track headers: track name, record arm, mute/solo, input selection and more.
3	Ruler: time (or bars and beats). Click it to move the playback position there.
4	Track lanes: where your recordings (clips) appear as waveforms.
5	Playhead (orange line): the current playback / recording position.
6	Mixer: volume, pan and effects for every track. Drag its top edge to change its height.
7	Status bar: the audio device in use and where recordings are saved.
8	Punch range: the part re-recorded with punch-in (chapter 7).

Transport bar

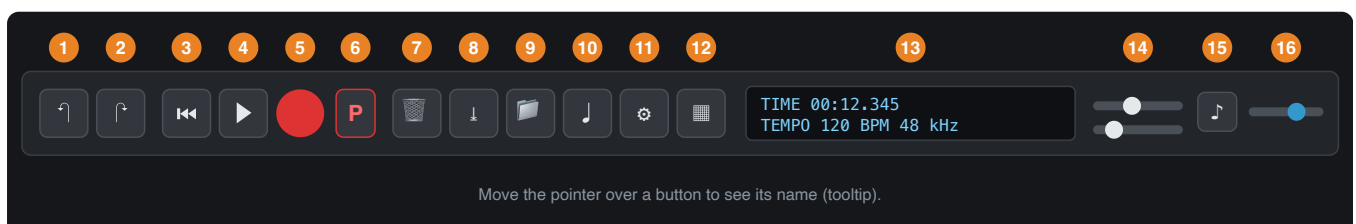


Figure 3-2 Transport bar (hover over a button to see its name)

No.	Button	What it does
1	Undo	Undoes the last clip edit (⌘Z).
2	Redo	Redoes an undone edit (⇧⌘Z).
3	Rewind	Returns to the start, 00:00.000 (⏮).
4	Play / Pause	Starts and stops playback (Space). This button does not record.
5	Record (red circle)	Starts recording on record-armed (R) tracks.
6	P	Turns punch in/out on (chapter 7).
7	Delete	Deletes the selected clips or the selected range (Delete).
8	Save	Saves the project (⌘S).
9	Open	Opens a project (⌘O).
10	Metronome	Click on/off (change it while stopped).
11	Settings	Opens Settings (audio devices, language and more; chapter 15).
12	Snap	Makes clip moves and trims snap to beats.
13	Displays	TIME (position), TEMPO (type the BPM), FORMAT (recording format and sample rate).
14	View scaling	Horizontal zoom, track height, waveform height (chapter 12).
15	Ruler mode	Switches the ruler between time and bars/beats.
16	Master volume	Overall output volume.

Track header

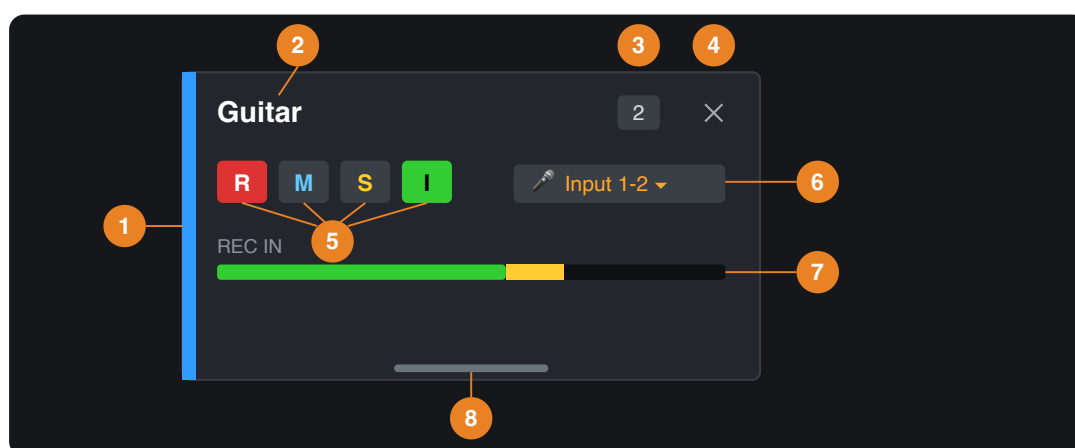


Figure 3-3 Track header

1	Colour bar: click to open a colour palette and change the track colour; “Custom...” lets you pick any colour.
2	Track name: double-click to rename.
3	1 / 2: mono (1) or stereo (2). Cannot be changed once the track contains recordings.
4	X: deletes the track.
5	R record arm, M mute, S solo (hear only this track), I input monitoring (chapter 8).
6	Input channel: the audio interface input used for recording.
7	Meter: input level while armed, output level otherwise.
8	Height: drag the bottom edge to change the track height.

To add a track, click the **+** (**Add Track**) button above the track headers.

4. Your first recording

Here you record one track and listen back to it.

- 1 **Choose a track:** click its **R** button so it turns red (armed).
- 2 **Choose the input:** in the input channel menu (figure 3-3, item 6) pick the input your microphone or guitar is connected to. For a single voice or guitar, set the track to **1** (mono).
- 3 **Check the level:** play and watch the meter. The loudest parts should reach about the yellow area. If it reaches red, turn down the input gain on your audio interface.
- 4 **Choose where to start:** click the ruler, or press **←** to start from the beginning.
- 5 **Record:** click the red **Record** button and perform. The waveform is drawn as you go.
- 6 **Stop:** press **Space**. The recording becomes a clip.
- 7 **Listen back:** turn off **R**, press **←**, then **Space**.

Recording along with a backing After the first track, add a new track, arm it and record in the same way. You will hear the first track while recording the second. While recording, older clips on the track being recorded are silenced.

Recording in time Type the BPM into TEMPO and turn on the metronome before recording to play along with a click (chapter 11).

Recording files Recordings are saved as WAV files in the Recordings folder. The file name contains the track name, channel count and sample rate.

5. Playback and basic controls

To...	Do this
Play / stop	 or the Play button
Go back to the start	 or the Rewind button
Jump to a position	Click the ruler (also while playing)
Hear only some tracks	 (solo) on those tracks
Silence some tracks	 (mute) on those tracks

When the playhead reaches the right edge during playback, the view scrolls on automatically. When stopped, use the scroll bar below the lanes to move around freely.

6. Editing clips

One recording is called a **clip**. Editing never changes the original recording file (non-destructive editing), so feel free to experiment.

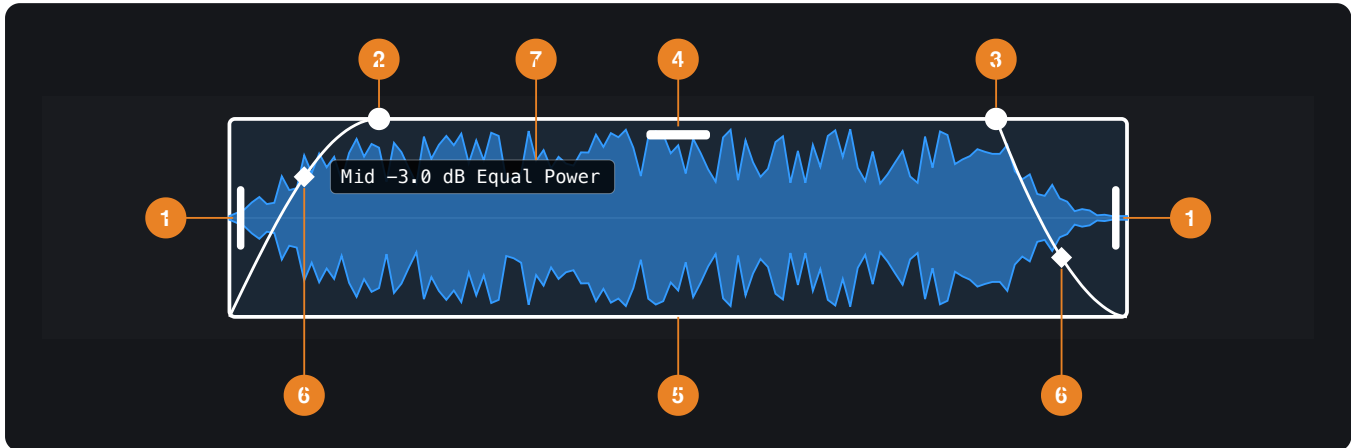


Figure 6-1 Clip handles

1	Left / right edges (trim): drag to shorten or lengthen the audible part.
2	Fade in: drag the white dot at the top left to the right so the sound starts gradually.
3	Fade out: drag the white dot at the top right to the left so the sound ends gradually.
4	Gain: drag the bar at the top centre up or down to change the clip volume (± 24 dB).
5	Body: click to select (thick white frame), drag to move — also onto another track.
6	Fade curve: the white diamond in the middle of each fade line. Drag it up or down to change the fade's shape (see “Shaping a fade” below).
7	Value readout: while you hold handle 2, 3, 4 or 6, a small box shows the fade length, the clip volume (dB) or the curve shape.

Waveforms are drawn at the level you will actually hear: they shrink along the fade curves, and raising or lowering the gain makes them taller or shorter.

Shaping a fade

Drag the diamond in the middle of a fade line (figure 6-1, item 6) up or down to bend the fade. The readout shows the level at the exact middle of the fade.

Diamond position	Fade shape
Moved up	Bowed up: a fade-in rises quickly; a fade-out holds its level and drops late.
Middle at -3.0 dB (Equal Power)	Keeps the perceived level steady — the best shape for crossfades. The diamond snaps here when close.
Middle at -6.0 dB (Linear)	A straight line. The diamond snaps here when close.
Moved down	Sagging: a fade-in rises slowly; a fade-out drops early.

Double-click the diamond to return to **Auto**: linear for a fade against silence, equal power for a crossfade over another clip. If a fade is too short to show its diamond, zoom in horizontally.

Selecting clips

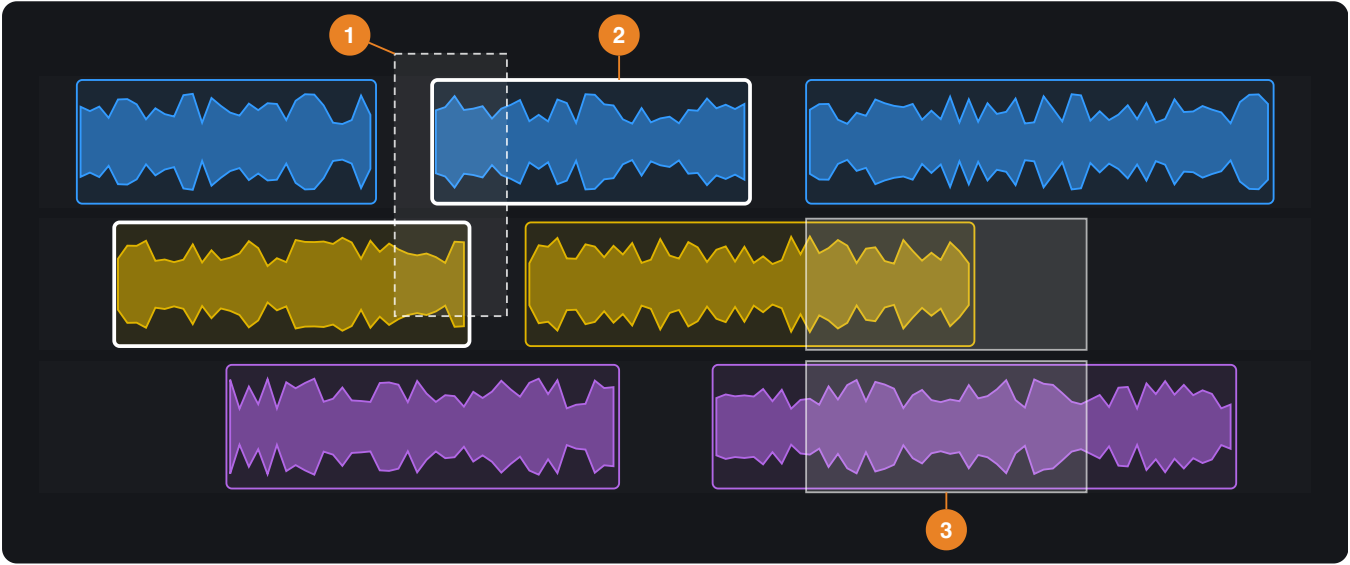


Figure 6-2 Marquee (1), the clips it selected (2), and a range selection (3)

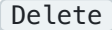
To...	Do this
Select one clip	Click it
Add to / remove from the selection	 -click or  -click
Select several at once (marquee)	Drag from an empty spot to draw a frame (figure 6-2, item 1). Every clip the frame touches is selected (item 2), across tracks too.
Add with a marquee	 -drag
Select everything	 A
Clear the selection	Click an empty spot, or press 

Dragging any selected clip moves all selected clips together (also up or down to other tracks).

Selecting a time range

Instead of whole clips, you can select “from this second to that second”. Use it to remove or keep just part of a clip.

- 1 Hold  and drag from where the range should start to where it should end. You can start on a clip or on an empty spot.
- 2 The range is shown as a white band (figure 6-2, item 3). Drag up or down to extend it over several tracks.
- 3 Then use one of these:

Action	Result
 (or right-click → Delete Range)	Removes the audio inside the range (leaving silence). Clips are split at the range edges.
Right-click → Crop to Range	Keeps only the audio inside the range and removes what is before and after it.
Right-click → Split at Range Edges	Splits clips at both ends of the range.
  /  	Copies / cuts only the audio inside the range.

Cut, copy, paste and duplicate

-   (cut),   (copy): take the selected clips (or, with a range selected, the audio in the range).
-   (paste): pastes at the **playhead**. Material copied from several tracks keeps its layout, with its top track landing on the **selected track**.
-  -drag a clip: leaves a copy in place while you move it (applies to every selected clip).
- Cut / Copy / Paste at Playhead are also in the right-click menu.

While typing a name When you are typing in a text field (such as a track name),  ,  ,   and   edit the text instead.

Right-click menu

- **Cut / Copy / Paste at Playhead:** cut, copy, and paste at the playhead.
- **Delete Range / Crop to Range / Split at Range Edges:** shown only while a range is selected.
- **Normalize:** sets the clip's gain so its loudest sample reaches 0 dBFS (the 24-bit maximum). The whole recording is measured, including parts hidden by trimming. The audio file is not changed (the gain limit is +24 dB).
- **Reverse:** plays the clip backwards. A reversed WAV file is written to Recordings and the clip switches to it. Fade lengths and shapes swap ends as well.
- **Choose Recording File...:** picks the file again if it cannot be found.
- **Mute / Unmute Recording:** silences just this clip.
- **Duplicate Recording:** places a copy right after it.

- **Split at Cursor:** splits the clip in two at the playhead.
- **Delete Recording:** deletes it.

If you right-click one of several selected clips, Normalize and Reverse apply to all of them.

Snap

With Snap on (figure 3-2, item 12), clip moves, trims and range selections snap to whole beats. Turn it off for fine positioning.

Undo and redo

Moves, trims, fade lengths and shapes, gain, delete, split, duplicate, range edits, cut and paste, normalize and reverse can be undone with Z and redone with Z (while stopped).

7. Punch-in recording and layered takes

Use this when a take is almost perfect except for a few bars: re-record only that part.

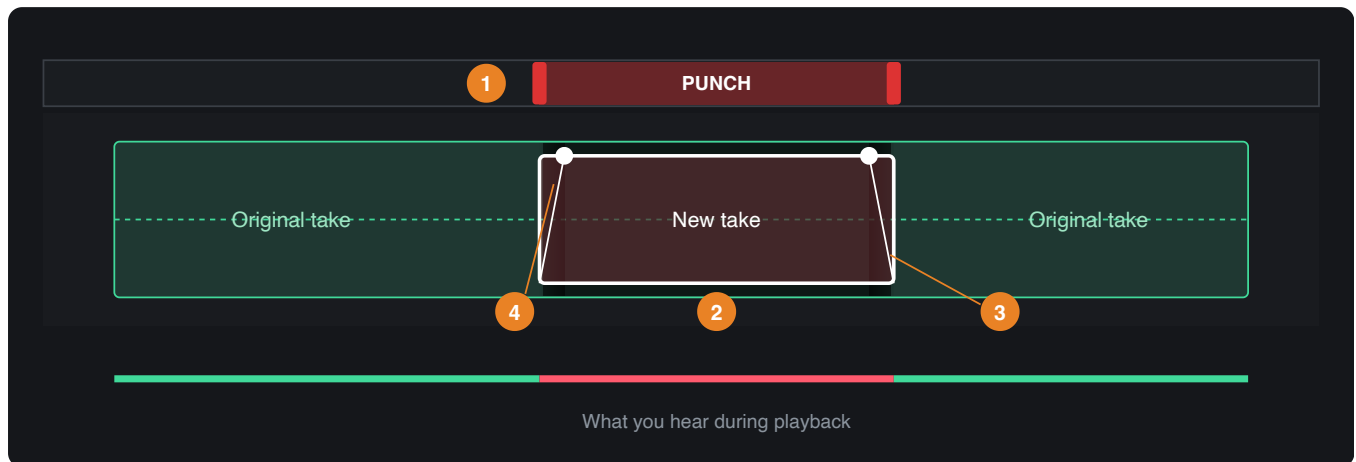


Figure 7-1 Punch range and the re-recorded part on top

- 1 Drag the red handles of the **punch range** on the ruler (figure 7-1, item 1) to the part you want to redo (they move in beats).
- 2 Click **P** in the transport bar to enable punch in/out (the range turns red).
- 3 Turn on **R** on the track to redo.
- 4 Click Record a little before the range and perform. Only what falls inside the range is used.
- 5 When you stop, the new part appears as a new clip (item 2) on top of the original clip.

How overlapping clips play

- Where clips overlap, **only the clip recorded later (the upper clip) plays**. The hidden part of the original clip is shown darker, with a flat (silent) waveform.
- The joins automatically get a **crossfade** (item 3), so there are no gaps or clicks. The default is 10 ms with an equal-power shape. Across the crossfade the upper clip's waveform grows while the lower clip's shrinks.
- Moving the fade handles of the upper clip (item 4) changes the crossfade length, and the diamond in the middle of the fade line changes its shape (chapter 6). The lower clip automatically gets the same shape mirrored. The lower clip's fade on the overlapped side cannot be edited.
- If you move or delete the upper clip, the lower clip automatically plays normally again.
- You can punch in as many times as you like over the same place. The last take is always on top, and every join gets its own crossfade.

Fine-tuning the range The whole pass is saved, including audio outside the range. Drag the edges of the upper clip to extend the re-recorded part.

This rule applies to every overlap Not only punch takes: whenever clips overlap after moving or duplicating, the clip on the higher layer wins.

Clip layers (which clip is on top)

- The layer order is **the order in which clips were added to the track**: the later a clip was recorded, the higher it is.
- Dragging a clip within the same track does **not** change its layer. For example, you cannot bring the first punch take above the second by moving it.
- Clips made with **Duplicate Recording** or paste (V), and clips moved to another track, are placed on **top** of that track.
- With -drag, the copy left behind sits directly below the clip you moved.

8. Recording through effects (input monitoring)

Use this, for example, to hear your guitar through an amp simulator while recording.

- 1 Insert the effect you want (e.g. an amp simulator) on the track (chapter 10).
- 2 Turn on **R** and **I** on the track. When I is filled green you hear the input through the effects (also while stopped).
- 3 Record with the Record button as usual.

Turning I on while playing Input monitoring cannot be rewired during playback. If you turn I on while playing, you start hearing the input after you stop, once reverb and other tails have faded (usually 1–2 s, at most 8 s). If you turn I off while playing, the input stays audible until you stop. Switching I while stopped takes effect at once.

The dry signal is recorded The file contains the sound before the effects, so you can change the amp settings later.

If you hear a delay Set **Buffer size** to 128 or 256. If your audio interface's direct monitoring is on, you will hear the dry and processed sound doubled — turn direct monitoring down for that input.

Feedback With a microphone and speakers you may get feedback (a loud squeal). Use headphones.

9. Using the mixer

The mixer at the bottom sets each track's level, left-right position (pan) and effects. Tracks come first, then FX channels, with MASTER (the overall output) at the right.

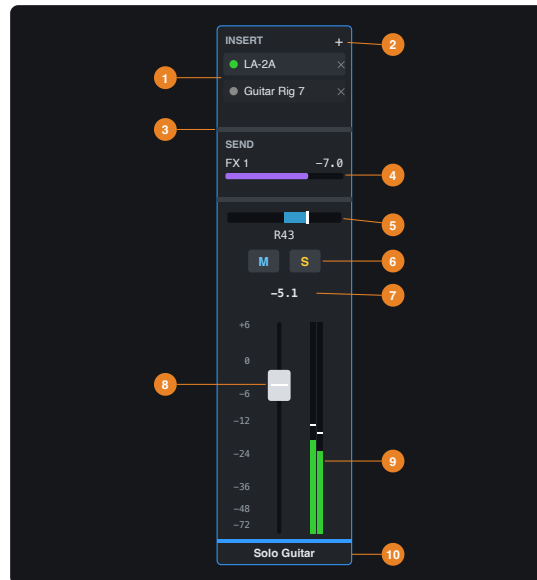


Figure 9-1 One mixer channel (strip)

1	INSERT (plug-in list): green dot turns a plug-in on/off, click the name to open its window, drag to reorder, X removes it.
2	+ : adds a plug-in.
3	Section divider: drag up or down to change the height of the INSERT, SEND and control sections (all channels together).
4	SEND: how much goes to an FX channel. Drag sideways, or double-click the value to type it.
5	Pan: drag sideways to place the sound left or right. <C> is centre, L56 left, R75 right.
6	M / S: mute and solo.
7	Level value: current fader value in dB. Double-click to type (e.g. -6, -inf).
8	Fader: drag up or down to change the level. 0 dB is the reference; you can go up to +6 dB.
9	Meters (L / R): level of each side. Green → yellow (from -12 dB) → red (from -6 dB). The white line shows the recent peak.
10	Name: click to select the track. Double-click an FX channel's name to rename it.

Handy actions

- -click: resets faders and sends to 0 dB and pan to centre.
- -drag: fine adjustment.
- Drag the mixer's top edge: changes the height of the whole mixer.

- Right-click in the mixer: **Add FX** adds an FX channel.

Level tip Adjust the track faders so the MASTER meter does not reach red. If the mix is too loud, lower the tracks rather than MASTER.

10. Effects (plug-ins) and FX channels

Inserting an effect

- 1 Stop playback (plug-ins cannot be inserted while playing).
- 2 Click  in the channel's INSERT section and choose a plug-in.
- 3 Click the plug-in's name to open its window.

Sound passes through the plug-ins from top to bottom. Drag the names to change the order. Plug-ins on MASTER's **POST** section affect the whole song (a limiter, for example).

Supported formats Audio Unit (AU) and VST3 effects. If a product is installed in both formats, only the AU version is listed (using both at once is unstable). Instruments are not supported.

FX channels (sharing a reverb)

Spatial effects such as reverb are usually placed once on an FX channel; each track then decides how much it sends (SEND).

- 1 Click **Add FX** at the top of the mixer (or right-click → Add FX).
- 2 Insert a reverb on the FX channel and set its Mix (dry/wet) to 100% wet.
- 3 Raise the SEND to that FX on each track.

A send carries the track's sound after its effects, fader and pan, so lowering a track's fader also lowers its reverb.

Automatic delay compensation

Some plug-ins need time to process audio (latency). MyDAW reads the latency they report and adjusts playback timing automatically.

11. Tempo, click and ruler

- **Tempo (BPM):** type a number into TEMPO (20–400, default 120).
- **Metronome:** turn it on before playing or recording to hear a click; the first beat of a bar is higher. Switch it while stopped.
- **Ruler:** button 15 in figure 3-2 switches between time and bars/beats.
- **Click timing and volume:** **Click timing offset** (ms) and **Click volume** in the settings.

12. Adjusting the view

Adjustment	How
Horizontal zoom	Magnifier buttons, the timeline slider (20–400 pixels per second), the mouse wheel over the ruler , or a trackpad pinch
Height of all tracks	Track height slider (0.5–3×), or  + mouse wheel over the tracks
Height of one track	Drag the bottom edge of its header
Waveform height	Waveform slider (1–32×), or   + mouse wheel over the tracks. Does not change the sound.
Mixer height	Drag the mixer's top edge

Zooming with the wheel or a pinch keeps the position under the pointer in place.

13. Saving, opening and moving projects

What a project contains

```
MySong/
├── MySong.mydaw      ← tracks, clip positions, mixer, plug-in settings, ...
└── Recordings/      ← your recorded WAV files
    └── *.wav
```

- **Save:**  or the Save button.
- **Open:**  or the Open button, then choose the project folder.
- **New:** .

Saved with the project: track settings (name, colour, volume, pan, mute, solo, input, R/I), clip positions and edits, mixer and FX, plug-ins and their settings, tempo, metronome, punch range and view settings.

Moving to another Mac Copy (or zip) the **whole project folder**, not just the .mydaw file. Install the plug-ins you use on the other Mac too. Renaming or moving the Recordings folder makes clips impossible to load.

Quitting When you close the window you are asked whether to save (Save / Don't Save / Cancel).

14. Importing WAV files and exporting

Importing a WAV file

- 1 Select the WAV file in Finder.
- 2 Drag it onto a track lane. It is added as a clip at the playhead.

The file is copied into the project's Recordings folder (the original is untouched). Files at a different sample rate, and 16-bit or 32-bit files, are **converted automatically to a 24-bit WAV at the current sample rate** as they are copied. Converting a long file may briefly pause the screen.

Exporting the finished mix

- 1 Stop playback and recording.
- 2 Choose **File** → **Export Master Mix...** and pick where to save.
- 3 Check the start and end times (seconds). The default end covers all clips.
- 4 Click **Export**. Exporting takes as long as playing the song.

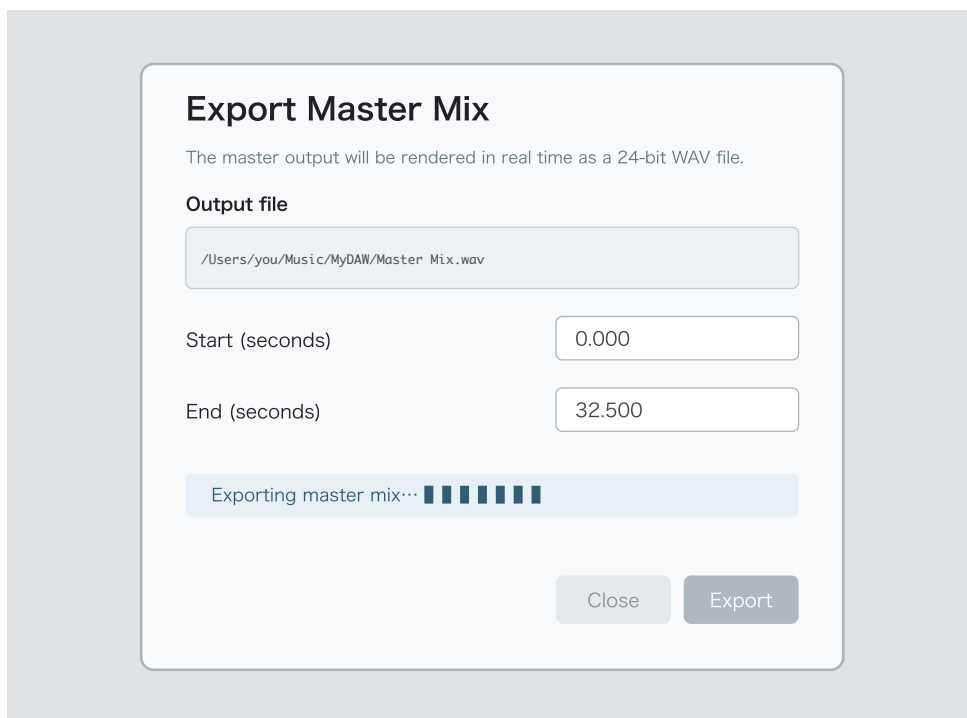


Figure 14-1 Export Master Mix dialog

15. Settings (audio and language)

Open **Settings** with the gear button (not available while playing or recording). Click **Apply** after changing anything.

Settings
Input and output devices use the same Core Audio buffer size.

- 1 Recordings folder:
- 2 Language:
- 3 Input device:
- 4 Output device:
- 5 Sample rate:
- 6 Recording delay compensation: ms
- 7 Click timing offset: ms
- 8 Click volume: 70%
- 9 Buffer size:

Figure 15-1 Settings

1	Recordings folder: where recordings are saved (normally the project's Recordings folder).
2	Language: the screen language (English / 日本語). At first it follows the macOS language.
3	Input device: the device you record from.
4	Output device: the device you listen through. It can be the same audio interface as the input or a different device (such as a monitor's speakers).
5	Sample rate: 44.1, 48, 88.2 or 96 kHz. This changes the device's own setting (the one shown in macOS Audio MIDI Setup).
6	Recording delay compensation: manual correction of recording position (ms). Positive values move recordings earlier. Normally leave at 0.
7	Click timing offset: shifts when the click sounds (-500 to +500 ms).
8	Click volume: loudness of the click.
9	Buffer size: smaller means less delay, larger means more stability. Use 128–256 for recording and input monitoring, 512–1024 for mixing.

Changes that need a restart When you change Language, Input device, Output device or Sample rate and click Apply, MyDAW asks to restart. Choose **Save and Restart**, **Restart Without Saving**, or **Cancel** (restart yourself later). After the restart the project that was open opens again. A Buffer size change alone takes effect without a restart.

MyDAW also switches the macOS sound devices While it runs, MyDAW makes your chosen input and output the macOS default input and output, and puts the previous ones back when it quits. So while MyDAW is running, other apps also play through the chosen output. If MyDAW crashes they are not restored — set them back in System Settings → Sound.

16. Keyboard shortcuts

Key	Action
Space	Play / stop
←	Go to the start
Delete	Delete the selected clips (or the audio in the selected range)
⌘X / ⌘C / ⌘V	Cut / copy / paste at the playhead
⌘A	Select all clips
Esc	Clear the selection
⌘Z	Undo
⇧⌘Z / ⌘Y	Redo
⌘S	Save
⌘O	Open
⌘N	New project
⇧-click / ⌘-click (clip)	Add to / remove from the selection
Drag (empty spot) / ⇧-drag	Marquee select / add with a marquee
⌘-drag (tracks)	Select a time range
⌘-drag (clip)	Duplicate while moving
Double-click (fade diamond)	Reset the fade shape to Auto
Mouse wheel over the ruler / pinch	Horizontal zoom
⌘ + mouse wheel	Track height
⇧⌘ + mouse wheel	Waveform height
⌘-click (mixer)	Fader / send to 0 dB, pan to centre
⌘-drag (mixer)	Fine adjustment
Double-click (values, names)	Type a value / rename

17. Troubleshooting

Problem	What to check
Cannot record / meter does not move	Microphone permission (System Settings → Privacy & Security → Microphone), Input device, the track's R button, the input channel.
No sound	Output device, MASTER and track faders, M (mute) / S (solo), speaker or headphone volume.
Play does not record	Recording uses the red Record button; Play only plays.
Recordings are out of time	Check the buffer size, record the same sound again to measure the offset, and correct it with Recording delay compensation.
Effect input sounds late	Buffer size 128–256; turn down the interface's direct monitoring.
A plug-in is missing from the list	Make sure it is an effect (not an instrument). AU effects driven by MIDI are not listed either. Products with an AU version are listed as AU only.
Cannot add a plug-in	Stop playback first.
Cannot import a WAV	Check that the file is an intact audio file such as WAV. Other sample rates and bit depths are converted automatically.
No sound from the chosen output device	After changing devices, restart MyDAW from the dialog. The new device is used only after the restart.
Other apps also play through MyDAW's output	While MyDAW runs, the chosen devices are the macOS defaults. They are put back when MyDAW quits.
After a crash, the Mac still uses MyDAW's devices	Set output and input back in System Settings → Sound.
A clip says its file cannot be found	Right-click → Choose Recording File... and pick the WAV again.
You want the screens in Japanese (or English)	Choose it under Language in Settings, click Apply and restart.

18. Glossary

Term	Meaning
DAW	Digital Audio Workstation — software for recording, editing and mixing.
Track	A lane that records and plays one instrument or part.
Clip	One recorded piece of audio that you can move and edit.
Record arm	Making a track ready to record with its R button.
Punch in/out	Re-recording only a chosen range.
Crossfade	Joining two sounds by fading one out while fading the other in.
Fade curve	The shape in which the level changes during a fade: linear, equal power, bowed up, sagging, and so on.
Equal power	A fade shape that keeps the perceived level steady through a crossfade.
Range selection	Selecting a stretch of time rather than whole clips.
Normalize	Raising or lowering a level so the loudest sample reaches full scale (0 dBFS).
Fader	The control that sets volume.
Pan	Where the sound appears between left and right.
dB (decibel)	Unit of level. 0 dB is the reference; -6 dB is roughly half as loud.
Mute / solo	Silence a track / hear only that track.
Plug-in (effect)	Add-on software that processes sound; formats AU and VST3.
INSERT	Effects placed directly on a channel; sound passes through them top to bottom.
SEND / FX channel	Sending part of a track's sound to a shared effect (the FX channel).
MASTER	The final output where all tracks are combined.
Buffer size	The block size audio is processed in. Smaller means less delay but more CPU load.
Sample rate	How many times per second sound is measured (44.1 / 48 / 88.2 / 96 kHz).
Input monitoring	Listening to the incoming sound through the track's effects.